

Job Grading: employer / management brief

Day 3 · Session 2 | Both sectors | Assigned-role brief

YOUR ROLE: Employer / management team

FICTIONAL TRAINING EXERCISE. Use only your assigned role. A role label separates downloads for the exercise; files on this public website are accessible to anyone with the link.

CONFIDENTIAL BRIEF — MANAGEMENT / EMPLOYER-SIDE TEAM

You represent Kiptenai County Referral Hospital management and the County Public Service Board.

Your constraint: The county's wage bill is already close to the statutory wage-bill ceiling under Kenya's public-finance rules — a topic this workshop returns to in depth on Day 4. This financial year's budget is already committed. More importantly: under the public service job evaluation framework introduced on Day 2, Session 2, upward regrading of a cadre generally requires a job evaluation exercise conducted through the SRC framework — you cannot simply grant a regrade unilaterally, however sympathetic the case.

What you must avoid: Simply saying "we cannot regrade you" and stopping there. In the conflict-path terms from Day 1, an unexplained refusal like that is an aggravator, not a moderator — exactly the kind of behaviour that pushes a manageable interest dispute toward escalation.

Options available to you: A proposal for an interim specialised-duty allowance, distinct from regrading, subject to required SRC advice, approvals and lawful appropriation. A training/CPD allocation may fund remuneration only if lawful reallocation and all necessary approvals are available; a written, dated commitment to formally submit a job evaluation request for the radiography cadre to the relevant authority within a defined period; additional continuing professional development (CPD) funding or study leave as non-monetary value; a phased or partial backdating of the allowance, if fiscal space allows, distinct from full backdated regrading.

Anticipate: The union team may cite a comparable facility that has already upgraded equivalent staff. Do not dispute this fact defensively — instead, be ready to explain honestly what is different about your own fiscal position, and what you CAN offer given it.

Your walk-away point: You cannot commit to a full backdated Job Group upgrade today — that decision is not within your unilateral authority. You CAN commit to: a lawful interim measure subject to required advice, approvals and appropriation, and a specific, dated commitment to initiate the formal job evaluation request. Avoid leaving the negotiation having offered nothing concrete at all.